Cowabunga SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

MON OCT 19, 2026 DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · MON OCT 19 · NORTH PB

The S swell is building and the wind is asleep. Little Point this morning, before the W breeze.

building S groundswell, glassy early: paddle out by 7:30

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Little Point

WINDOW	7:30–11a · Inferno 72 · ~72°F
SURF	3–6 ft (SRF), long lulls at 15s
TIDE	H 3.8 @ 6:57a L 3.1 @ 11:31a H 4.2 @ 4:49p obs 5.1 @ 5:48a

Read the tide gauge, not just the table.

PADDLE OUT BY

7:30

BOARD
Inferno 72
~72°F WATER

8 /10

SURF RATING · GOOD · LIVE

Very good — move a meeting

scorecard 0.86 · Better than 81% of 36 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

3–6 FT (SRF), LONG LULLS AT 15S

GROUND
SwH 3.6–4.6 ft · 15s

WINDSWELL
WWH 1.3 ft · 10s

HS BUOY
Hs 4.6 ft · 46258



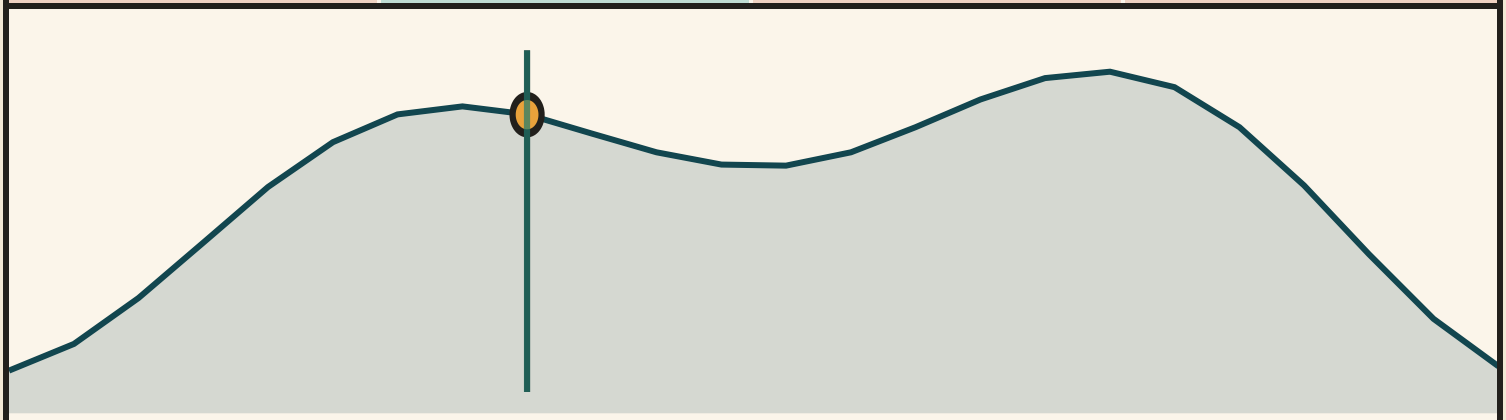
FROM
190° S

Buoy 46258 · Hs 4.6 ft @ 15s S (spectrum SwH 3.6–4.6 ft @ 15–18s overnight, building) + WWH 1.3 ft @ 10s · face 3–6 ft (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 S 4 ft @ 15s + W 2 ft @ 12s · MWD 190° S · wind calm early, W 10 mph from 1p

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

PRE-7:30A · FOG, FULL TIDE	7:30–11A · LITTLE POINT	11A–1P · LIGHT W	1–6P · W 10 MPH + CEILING
WAIT	GO	MEH	SKIP



8:00a	GO · Little Point	3.7 ft tide	Calm · NWS	3–6 ft (SRF), long lulls at 15s

H 3.8 @ 6:57a · L 3.1 @ 11:31a · H 4.2 @ 4:49p · obs 5.1 @ 5:48a

Little Point, 7:30 to about 11a, on the Inferno 72. Table tides: H 3.8 @ 6:57a, L 3.1 @ 11:31a, H 4.2 @ 4:49p. The gauge read 5.14 ft at 5:48a against 3.68 predicted, about 1.5 ft over the table, so the reef sits near 5.3 ft at the morning high and eases toward 4.6 ft late morning, never close to the 3.0 ft floor. It climbs back over the 5.5 ft ceiling around 3 to 5p. LJAC1 is calm to 1 kt ENE at 5a. NWS hourly has calm wind through 9a, W 5 mph 10a to noon, then W 10 mph 1 to 4p (PZZ740 variable under 10 kt becoming W 10 kt this afternoon). Patchy fog until about 8a. Sunrise 6:55a, sunset 6:12p.

Where it's working

Little Point

★

Top of the scorecard at 0.86. The S groundswell is building overnight (46258 SwH 3.6–4.6 ft @ 15–18s, last reading Hs 4.6 ft @ 15s, MWD 190° at 5:26a). The angle is a touch more southerly than yesterday, so it scores a bit lower on swell fit, but the period and size are right. The gauge is running about 1.5 ft over the table (5.14 ft at 5:48a vs 3.68 predicted), so the reef sits near 5.3 ft at the 6:57a high, right under its 5.5 ft ceiling, then drains toward about 4.6 ft by 11a. Calm wind until 9a, light W 5 mph from 10a. Paddle out by 7:30.

CALL

2

PB north of the pier

Score 0.72. Clean tide and wind, but the S angle mostly misses the pier wedge, and the W 2 ft @ 12s in PZZ740 is too small to carry it.

SOFT

3

Calumet

Score 0.65. Good swell angle, but flagged tide-high vs its window with the gauge this full. Pass.

SOFT

4

PB Drive

Score 0.61. Flagged oversize for the sandbar; 15-second sets at this size tend to close out. Only if the reef is packed; bring the Anvil.

SOFT

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Skip · PB Point (0.51) and Tourmaline (0.50) are too full on the high gauge. The Cliffs (Garbage, Abs, Luscomb's) and OB want W groundswell and lower tide; today is a S primary on a full tide. Blacks and Scripps (extended only) will show bigger sets on a S 15-second swell, but the full tide softens them and the walk eats the glassy window, so they do not beat a clean local reef.

SKIP

BOARD

Inferno 72

~72°F

QUIVER

Sharp Eye Inferno 72

Chest-to-head 15-second groundswell on a steep reef with glassy wind. Yesterday proved the Anvil is too flat for these faces.

Anvil twin · only if you end up on the Drive sandbar
TW log · too much push for it today

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Read the tide gauge, not just the table.

The table says 3.8 ft at 6:57a, but the La Jolla gauge is reading about a foot and a half higher. Warm water, a southerly swell, and low pressure can all lift the sea above the forecast. On a shallow reef like Little Point that extra water decides whether a wave stands up or rolls through soft, so check the observed level before you trust the printed tide.

SKIP

The afternoon: W 10 mph from 1p and a gauge-adjusted tide back over the 5.5 ft ceiling around 3 to 5p. PB Drive on oversized 15-second closeouts. Calumet, Tourmo, and PB Point on a gauge this full. The Cliffs and OB on a S primary swell.

GOTCHAS

The buoy is still climbing (SwH 1.1 m at 2:56a to 1.4 m at 5:26a), so the sets may get bigger through the morning than they look at first light. Fifteen-second sets come in groups with long lulls, so watch a full set cycle before paddling out. Patchy fog early. High rip current risk and a Beach Hazards Statement through 9a Tuesday (NWS SRF). Sunny and warm, near 76°F by noon.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL · Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES